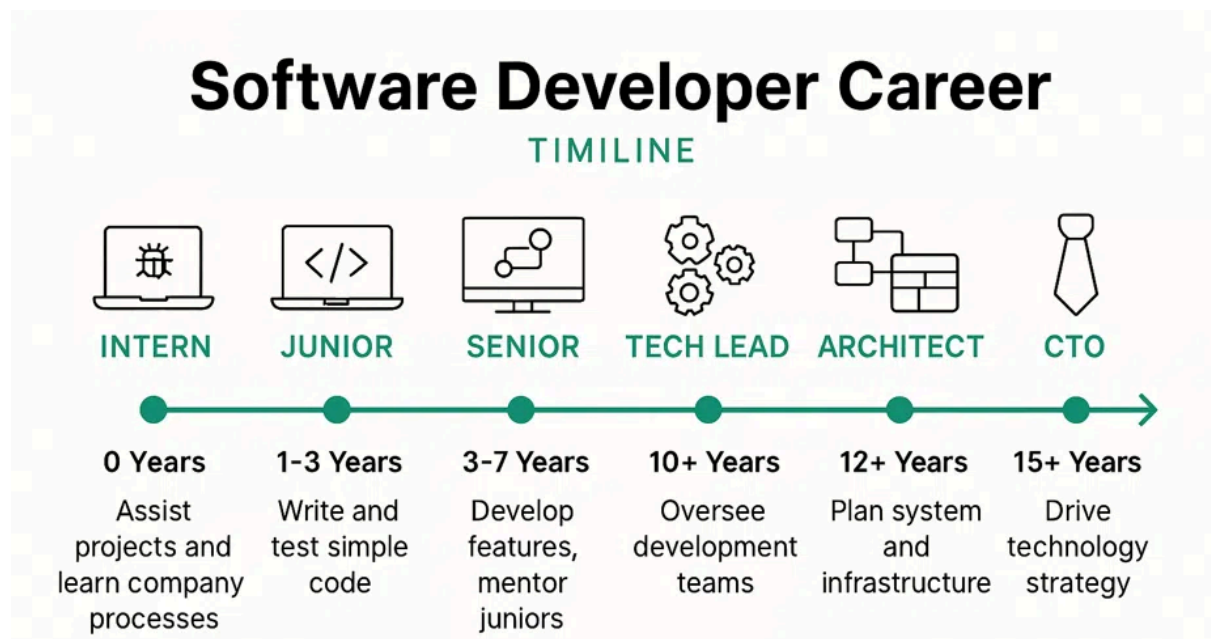


Currently, software engineering is a highly sought-after profession due to its generous salary and broad, clear career advancement opportunities. The level of skill, experience, and specific responsibilities are assessed based on different skill levels and experience.

Software engineer career progression



Having a clear career path is something everyone strives for. The same applies to becoming a software engineer.

The higher the rank of a software engineer, the greater the benefits and power. Below is the hierarchical sequence of career paths that a software engineer aims for:

- Level 1: Software Engineer Intern
- Level 2: Junior Software Engineer
- Level 3: Software Engineer
- Level 4: Senior Software Engineer

Upon reaching Level 4 Senior Software Engineer, there are two career paths to pursue:

- Chuyên gia: Staff Engineer -> Senior Staff Engineer -> Principal Engineer
- Quản lý: Engineering Manager -> Director of Engineering

Software Engineer Intern

This is the entry-level position in the software engineer career progression path. Internships in this role typically last around 3 months.

- **Number of years of experience** Third or fourth-year students majoring in Information Technology or related fields.
- **Income level:** Support ranges from 1 to 3 million VND per month.

In the initial phase, most interns familiarize themselves with processes, tools, and teamwork skills under the guidance of experienced software engineers. This is an opportunity to understand the features and descriptions of the product, which will be helpful for future work. In addition, interns are also responsible for assisting software engineers in the team with various professional tasks.

Junior Software Engineer

After approximately 3 months of internship, if you perform well, you will start as a Junior Software Engineer.

- **Number of years of experience** Less than 1-2 years of experience, Bachelor's degree in Information Technology/Computer Engineering/Electronics Engineering or equivalent.
- **Income level** Average salary: 8 - 12 million VND/month.

At this stage, Junior Software Engineers will learn and gain necessary experience by working on real-world software projects. From there, they can apply important computer science knowledge to practice. Junior Software Engineers also become familiar with processes, tools, and developing small-scale features. Furthermore, they

can proactively identify and propose improvement solutions, create tickets, and fix minor bugs.

Software Engineer

After one year of full-time work, you will have the opportunity to be considered for a Software Engineer position.

- **Number of years of experience** 1-3 years of experience
- **Income level** It can go up to over 20 million VND, depending on the size of the business and the level of specialized and diverse skills required.

In this role, a Software Engineer needs to be able to handle larger-scale tasks and bugs independently. They should develop medium-scale features and collaborate with programmers to create code.

In addition, Junior Software Engineers are responsible for testing and installing basic applications, and providing support and maintenance for the entire system.

Senior Software Engineer

This level requires at least 3 years of work experience. Strong expertise and excellent leadership skills are essential to guide and mentor a team of software engineers.

- **Number of years of experience:** 3-5+ years of work experience
- **Income level:** Income ranges from 25 to 33 million VND per month.

With extensive experience in the field, a Senior Software Engineer's responsibilities include guiding and managing project teams, breaking down large tasks into smaller ones, and distributing them efficiently.

Finding dead code and ensuring proper testing are also crucial. Additionally, Senior Software Engineers need to be flexible in suggesting areas for product and technical improvement, ensuring that tasks are aligned with the technology strategy.

Expert-level Software Engineer

After developing to the Senior level, software engineers can choose to pursue a specialist career path.

Staff Engineer

- **Number of years of experience:** 7-10+ years of experience
- **Income level** From \$1,500 to \$2,000 per month.

Staff Engineers play a crucial role in business operations, making decisions about the design and architecture of the system's core. Furthermore, they are responsible for solving highly complex technical challenges.

Senior Staff Engineer

- **Number of years of experience:** +12 years of experience
- **Income level** Over \$2000/month

Senior Staff Engineers are regularly involved in the strategic planning and decision-making of a business. They support the modification of team roadmaps based on established technology strategies to identify and develop business opportunities. Senior Staff Engineers also serve as the main point of contact with the engineering teams of partner companies to determine whether integration is feasible.

Principal Engineer

- **Number of years of experience:** +12 years of experience
- **Income level** Reaching \$3000/month, or even more.

This level is equivalent to the management board. The person in the Principal Engineer position will be involved in designing strategies for the company's key products.

Management-level Software Engineer

Besides the path to becoming a top expert, the career path to becoming a brilliant manager is also attractive if you have the necessary expertise and skills.

Engineering Manager

- Capable of managing other managers and managing a team of 20-40 people.
- **Income level** From \$1,500 to \$2,500 per month.

This position involves overseeing a team of engineers to complete engineering projects. Responsibilities include recruiting and training technical staff, establishing budgets, schedules, and project timelines, and supporting testing, inspection, and troubleshooting.

Director of Engineering

- Typically, these are executives, CTOs (Chief Technology Officers), or VPs.
- Lead and manage all personnel in the IT department, including programmers.
- Under the direct management of the Board of Directors.
- Income level: From 3000 – 4000 USD/month.

As a senior management position with a background in engineering, the Director of Engineering is responsible for managing, directing, and allocating resources effectively to ensure the project progresses as planned.

The primary responsibility of a Director of Engineering also includes motivating, inspiring, and making final decisions for the team. They are a leader who guides everything towards the company's mission.

Steps to Start a Career in Gaming Engineering

